

Expiry Moves the Close, Not the Day: Natural Experiments from India's Changing Options Expiry Calendar

Title Page

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Running head: Options expiry and settlement-window volatility in India

Statements and Declarations

Ethical approval: Not applicable. The study uses publicly available market data only.

Consent to participate: Not applicable.

Consent for publication: Not applicable.

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Data availability statement: Price data are publicly available from Yahoo Finance. One-minute index data are publicly available from the Hugging Face dataset *thetrade/markk/india-index-options-1m* (CC BY-NC 4.0),

and NSE end-of-day contract files from the Hugging Face dataset *rissin/nse-options-intraday*. The code that downloads the data and reproduces every table and figure, together with the reconstructed expiry calendar, is available at <https://github.com/vicky123411/india-expiry-volatility>.

Use of artificial intelligence tools: [Author to review and adapt to the journal’s policy before submission.] The author used an AI assistant (Claude, Anthropic) to write data-analysis code and to draft and edit the text of this article. The author reviewed and verified the analysis and the text and takes full responsibility for the content.

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